NodeDesk VR Participant Protocol Form

JOSHUA WEIHE

Participant Information

Participant ID: ____________________

Date: ____________________

Session Start Time: ____________________

Session End Time: ____________________

Research Statement:

A spatially organized Focus View navigation system in a VR desktop environment may improve navigation efficiency during repeated traversal of interconnected information networks.

Moderator Script

Read the following to the participant:

> Thank you for participating in this study.
>
> This prototype is a VR desktop environment designed for organizing and navigating interconnected information using spatial interaction techniques.
>
> The system includes spatial node organization, node linking, a Focus View mode, and directional joystick-based navigation between linked nodes.
>
> During this session, I will ask you to complete several short tasks. Please think aloud when possible and describe what feels intuitive, what feels confusing, and what you expect the system to do.
>
> There are no right or wrong answers. I am evaluating the interface, not your performance.

Task 1: Create and Arrange Nodes

Read aloud:

> Please create several nodes using the wrist menu. After creating them, arrange the nodes in positions that feel meaningful or organized to you.

Observation Notes:

Did the participant understand node creation?

Yes No Somewhat

Author's Contact Information: Joshua Weihe.

Did the participant naturally arrange nodes spatially?

Yes No Somewhat

Task 2: Create Links

Read aloud:

> Now, create links between nodes that you feel are related.

Observation Notes:

Did the participant understand the linking interaction?

Yes No Somewhat

Did the participant appear to understand the graph structure?

Yes No Somewhat

Task 3: Enter Focus View

Read aloud:

> Next, enter Focus View mode and select one of the nodes.

Observation Notes:

Did the participant understand the transition into Focus View?

Yes No Somewhat

Did Focus View improve readability?

Yes No Somewhat

Task 4: Navigate Between Linked Nodes

Read aloud:

> While remaining in Focus View, use the joystick to navigate between connected nodes. Try moving through the graph multiple times.

Observation Notes:

Did the participant understand joystick navigation?

Yes No Somewhat

Did the participant expect joystick direction to match the spatial layout?

Yes No Somewhat

Did the participant become more comfortable after repeated traversal?

Yes No Somewhat

Task 5: Exit Focus View

Read aloud:

> Please exit Focus View and return to the normal workspace.

Observation Notes:

Did the participant remain oriented after exiting Focus View?

Yes No Somewhat

Optional Free Interaction

Read aloud:

> Please use the system freely for one minute and describe any interaction patterns or organizational strategies you naturally develop.

Observation Notes:

Post-Study Survey

Use the following scale:

1 = Strongly Disagree   2 = Disagree   3 = Neutral   4 = Agree   5 = Strongly Agree

(1) The VR workspace felt intuitive to use.
1 2 3 4 5
(2) The spatial arrangement of nodes helped me understand relationships between information.
1 2 3 4 5
(3) Focus View reduced clutter and made information easier to navigate.
1 2 3 4 5
(4) Joystick-based navigation between linked nodes felt natural.
1 2 3 4 5
(5) I could maintain my sense of orientation while navigating between nodes.
1 2 3 4 5
(6) The interaction techniques were easy to learn.
1 2 3 4 5
(7) The system encouraged me to think spatially about connected information.
1 2 3 4 5

Short Response Questions

1. What part of the system felt most intuitive?

2. What part of the system felt confusing or difficult?

3. Did the directional joystick navigation match your expectations? Why or why not?

4. What improvements or additional features would you suggest?

Researcher Summary Notes

Main positive observations:

Main usability problems:

Notable participant quotes:

Overall takeaway from this session: